4-day Barcelona itinerary

Ready-made plan with opening hours and official ticket links · includes the free Tibidabo church visit

Check before you plan. Museums and attractions that need advance tickets may be sold out — check availability via the ticket links first. Hours are typical and change by season; many museums close on Mondays.

Day 1

Eixample's masterpieces & a free sunset view

EIXAMPLE → CARMEL HILLS

Day 1 mixes the big Gaudí house with a lesser-known Modernista castle and ends on a free viewpoint.

Book ahead: Sagrada Família; Casa Milà (La Pedrera). Check availability *before* you plan — popular slots can sell out days or weeks ahead.

09:00 — **Sagrada Família** TICKETED BOOK AHEAD

Gaudí's unfinished basilica — the single most visited monument in Spain. Allow about 1h30 inside, towers extra.

🕘 **Typically 09:00–18:00 (to 20:00 Apr–Sep); Sundays and holidays open later. Last entry about 30 min before closing.**

🚇 Metro L2 or L5, Sagrada Família.

⚠ *Check availability before you fix your plans — tickets or time slots may be sold out.*

Check availability & book official tickets →

11:30 — **Casa Milà (La Pedrera)** TICKETED BOOK AHEAD

Gaudí's wave-fronted apartment building, with a sculpted chimney-top roof terrace and an attic exhibition.

🕘 **Typically daily 09:00–20:30 (shorter hours in winter).**

🚇 Metro L3 or L5, Diagonal.

⚠ *Check availability before you fix your plans — tickets or time slots may be sold out.*

Check availability & book official tickets →

13:00 — **Lunch near Diagonal**

Quick tapas or a daily menu near La Pedrera.

14:30 **Casa de les Punxes** TICKETED

The 'House of Spikes' — Puig i Cadafalch's fairy-tale castle-like building with six pointed towers.

🕘 **Hours vary — check the official page.**

🚇 Metro L3 or L5, Diagonal.

Official page →

16:00 **Passeig de Gràcia & Rambla de Catalunya** SHOPPING

Barcelona's grandest shopping avenue, lined with Modernista façades, flagship stores and café terraces.

🕘 **Shops generally 10:00–20:00–21:00; many are closed on Sundays.**

🚇 Metro L2, L3 or L4, Passeig de Gràcia.

Open in Google Maps →

18:30 **Bunkers del Carmel viewpoint** FREE ENTRY

The best free panorama in town — 360° views of the city, sea and Sagrada Família, ideal at sunset.

🕘 **Open-air viewpoint; the hill closes at night. Go before dusk.**

🚌 Local bus to the Carmel area, then a short but steep uphill walk (check the route in a transport app).

Open in Google Maps →

20:30 **Dinner in Gràcia**

Walk or take the bus back down to Gràcia's terraces.

Day 2 Gothic Quarter, Born & Ciutadella

GOTHIC QUARTER → BORN → CIUTADELLA → BEACH

Day 2 explores the old town and its green park, ending on the sand.

Book ahead: Museu Picasso. Check availability *before* you plan — popular slots can sell out days or weeks ahead.
Closed Mondays: Museu Picasso. If you travel on a Monday, swap this day with another.

09:30

Barcelona Cathedral TICKETED

The Gothic seat of the Archbishop of Barcelona, with a cloister of white geese and rooftop views.

🕘 **Typically open from about 09:30; tourist-visit slots close around 18:30. Hours differ on Sundays and feast days.**

🚇 Metro L4, Jaume I — 5-minute walk.

Book official tickets →

10:45

Wander the Gothic Quarter FREE ENTRY

Plaça Sant Jaume, Carrer del Bisbe, the Roman walls and Plaça Reial — Barcelona's medieval core, best explored on foot.

🕘 **Open-air streets — always accessible.**

🚇 On foot — everything here is within a few minutes' walk.

Open in Google Maps →

11:30

Museu Picasso TICKETED BOOK AHEAD

Five medieval palaces holding one of the world's most complete collections of Picasso's early work.

🕘 **Typically Tue–Sun 10:00–19:00 (Thursdays to 21:30); closed Mondays.**

🚇 Metro L4, Jaume I — 5-minute walk.

⚠ *Check availability before you fix your plans — tickets or time slots may be sold out.*

Check availability & book official tickets →

13:00

Lunch in El Born

Try a vermuteria or a tapas bar off Passeig del Born.

14:30

Santa Maria del Mar FREE ENTRY

One of Barcelona's great Gothic churches, built by the sea-faring merchants of El Born — free to step inside.

🕘 **Hours vary (with closures for services and visits) — check before you go.**

🚇 Metro L4, Jaume I — 5-minute walk.

Open in Google Maps →

15:15 — **El Born Centre de Cultura i Memòria** FREE ENTRY

A glass-and-iron market hall with the excavated streets of the 1700 neighbourhood preserved beneath it.

🕘 **Hours vary by day — check the official page.**

🚇 5-minute walk from Santa Maria del Mar.

Official page & hours →

16:15 — **Parc de la Ciutadella & Arc de Triomf** FREE ENTRY

The city's main park: lake, fountain, the Cascada monument and the brick Arc de Triomf nearby.

🕘 **Park open daily; closes at dusk (about 18:00–21:00 by season).**

🚇 Metro L1, Arc de Triomf — or L4, Ciutadella | Vila Olímpica.

Open in Google Maps →

17:45 — **Barceloneta Beach & Port Vell** FREE ENTRY

The city beach, chiringuitos and the marina — the easiest place to swap sightseeing for sea air.

🕘 **Open-air — always accessible.**

🚇 Metro L4, Barceloneta.

Open in Google Maps →

20:00 — **Dinner on the seafront**

Rice and seafood in Barceloneta.

Day 3 — Park Güell, Tibidabo church, Sant Pau & Gràcia

PARK GÜELL → TIBIDABO → SANT PAU → GRÀCIA

Day 3 covers the northern hills, with the free hilltop church, then a UNESCO Modernista complex.

> Want the amusement park instead? **Tibidabo Amusement Park takes about half a day** — it would replace the afternoon of this day, so drop the later stops. Open days are limited: check the official calendar first.
> **Book ahead:** Park Güell; Casa Vicens. Check availability *before* you plan — popular slots can sell out days or weeks ahead.

09:00 — **Park Güell** TICKETED BOOK AHEAD

Gaudí's hillside garden city — the mosaic dragon, the colonnaded hall and the serpentine bench, with city views.

🕘 **Typically 09:30–19:30 (shorter in winter). Entry to the monumental zone is by timed ticket only.**

🚇 Metro L3 Vallcarca or Lesseps, then a 15–20 minute uphill walk (or a local bus).

⚠ *Check availability before you fix your plans — tickets or time slots may be sold out.*

Check availability & book official tickets →

11:15 — **Tibidabo — Sagrat Cor church & views** FREE ENTRY

The hilltop church above the city, with sweeping views over Barcelona and the coast. Entering the church is free.

🕘 **Church opening times vary — check before you go.**

🚇 FGC L7 to Avinguda Tibidabo, then the local bus or tram up and the Tibidabo funicular to the top — check what is running that day.

Open in Google Maps →

13:00 — **Lunch in Sarrià or Gràcia**

Choose a daily-menu restaurant on the way back down.

14:45 — **Hospital de Sant Pau** TICKETED

A UNESCO-listed Modernista hospital complex by Domènech i Montaner — painted pavilions linked by underground tunnels.

🕘 **Hours vary by season and day — check the official page.**

🚇 Metro L5, Sant Pau | Dos de Maig.

Official page & tickets →

16:45 — **Casa Vicens** TICKETED BOOK AHEAD

Gaudí's first major house, a colourful tiled summer home in Gràcia — now a museum.

🕘 **Hours vary by season and day — check the official page before you go.**

🚇 Metro L3, Fontana.

⚠ *Check availability before you fix your plans — tickets or time slots may be sold out.*

Check availability & book official tickets →

18:15 **Wander Gràcia** FREE ENTRY

Once its own town: small squares (Plaça del Sol, Plaça de la Vila de Gràcia), indie shops and neighbourhood cafés.

🕘 **Open-air — shops generally 10:00–20:00; many close on Sunday.**

🚇 Metro L3, Fontana — everything is walkable.

Open in Google Maps →

20:00 **Dinner in Gràcia**

Terraces on Plaça de la Vila de Gràcia or Plaça del Sol.

Day 4 Montjuïc, the Rambla & the Harbour

MONTJUÏC → RAMBLA → PORT

Day 4 combines a hilltop with the city's best-known boulevard and a boat ride.

Closed Mondays: MNAC — Museu Nacional d'Art de Catalunya. If you travel on a Monday, swap this day with another.

09:30 **Poble Espanyol** TICKETED

An open-air village of replica buildings from every region of Spain, with craft workshops and cafés.

🕘 **Opens about 09:00 daily; closing time varies by day (later on Fridays and weekends).**

🚇 Metro L1 or L3, Espanya, then a 15-minute uphill walk or bus.

Book official tickets →

11:30 **MNAC — Museu Nacional d'Art de Catalunya** TICKETED

Romanesque church frescoes, Gothic altarpieces and the grand palace terrace overlooking Plaça d'Espanya.

🕘 **Typically Tue–Sat 10:00–18:00 (to 20:00 in summer), Sun 10:00–15:00; closed Mondays.**

🚇 Metro L1 or L3, Espanya, then the escalators or a 10-minute uphill walk.

Book official tickets →

13:00 **Lunch in Poble-sec**

Pintxo bars on Carrer de Blai.

14:30 — **Montjuïc Cable Car & Castle** TICKETED

Ride the cable car up the hill and walk the ramparts of Montjuïc Castle for sweeping views over the port and city.

🕘 **Cable car typically 10:00–18:00 (to 20:00 in summer); the castle keeps similar daytime hours — closed in strong wind.**

🚇 Metro L2 or L3, Paral·lel, then the Montjuïc funicular to the cable car.

Official page & tickets →

17:00 — **Mercat de la Boqueria** FREE ENTRY

Barcelona's most famous food market — fruit stalls, jamón, fresh juices and tapas counters.

🕘 **Mon–Sat 08:00–20:30; closed Sundays.**

🚇 Metro L3, Liceu — right on La Rambla.

Open in Google Maps →

18:00 — **Las Golondrinas — Port & Coastline boat (60 min)** TICKETED

A classic harbour cruise past the port, the breakwater and the city's seafront.

🕘 **Departure times vary by season — check the official page.**

🚇 Metro L3, Drassanes, then a 10-minute walk to the Portal de la Pau.

Book official tickets →

20:00 — **Dinner near the port**

Tapas near Plaça Reial or along the Rambla de Mar.

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